Australian bushfires, causing the herd to panic and the bottom to drop out of share markets. But often good news or calm and sensible reporting isn't click bait: it doesn't cause us to watch or read—and it doesn't sell advertising. So, it's up to us to decipher and discern from our low base of financial understanding, which can be tough.

The problem is, this lack of broad-based financial storytelling is leading to low global levels of financial literacy.

This is reported over and over again in surveys conducted worldwide. The results of the 2018 Household and Labour Dynamics in Australia report showed that more than 50 per cent of Australians couldn't answer five basic financial literacy questions. In the US, the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority Inc's Investor Education Foundation's 2015 study reported that only 37 per cent of Americans were able to correctly answer four out of five financial questions. This represented a drop of 5 per cent from a 2009 study. While in the UK, a 2018 study conducted by the University College London and University of Cambridge found that 40 per cent of people couldn't correctly calculate a simple discount they might receive while shopping for everyday items.

Meanwhile, Standard & Poor's Ratings Services 2015 Global Financial Literacy Survey, which is a comprehensive evaluation of global financial literacy of over 140 countries and 150,000 people, found that only 33 per cent of adults worldwide were financially literate. They also discovered that there wasn't gender parity in financial literacy, surveyed men reporting 35 per cent literacy compared with women at 30 per cent. If we think back to the not enough Money Story, what I found interesting was that women surveyed were more likely to indicate that they didn't know the answer. Women would rather not attempt to answer the question at all, than to attempt to answer the question incorrectly.

While these low levels of financial literacy might in part be due to our lack of education, they're also due to our reluctance to talk about money, to share a range and depth of Money Stories and to understand how they're affecting us. Sadly, when it comes to our Money Stories, they're often limited to whether we think we're financially 'bad' or 'good'.

If you think of yourself as a spender, you probably assume you're bad with money. Conversely, if you've already determined yourself to be a saver, you might suppose you're good with money. Those who come from a